

COLUMN | AVNEET SINGH MARWAH

The next 20 years for the Smart TV industry



Avneet Singh Marwah, Director and CEO, Super Plastronics Pvt Ltd

From early times, television has played an important role in Indian families. After a day of hard work, we would gather around the television for “family time,” watching a common favourite episode. In the new millennium, technology, family structures, and consumer preferences have all changed. Smartphones have made content viewing a more personal experience, and traditional LED TVs have become outdated. With urbanisation, the OTT boom and the high-speed Internet availability with 4G, Smart TVs penetrated the urban cities.

Today, according to market research, the global smart TV market is valued at USD 202.1 billion and expected to register a CAGR of 16.52 per cent between 2021 to 2026.

Customers are evolving, and so are their needs

Customers, both residential and commercial, are evolving, and so are their needs and expectations from their TV. Gen Z, Gen Y and baby boomers are more technologically savvy and gadget-friendly than the previous generations. They want the best technology and experience while watching leisure content, office/ education-related information and even gaming. They are “smart” customers demanding an efficient and productive lifestyle through technology, encouraging innovation in the field of “smart living” as a concept.

Hence, Smart TVs have become an important lifestyle product for the generation. Smart TVs fit the demand for the best content viewing experience through larger screens, the latest technology, better sound and image resolution. They bring a complete cinematic viewing experience at home. Smart TVs also become a complete work-from-home solution for video conferencing, routine work and accessing documents on a larger screen. They also connect with other devices, such as smartphones, tablets, etc., so that content is accessible and shareable.

Beyond just content, Smart TVs are also developing into a single platform to integrate all smart devices. In future, our smart fridge will send data to the smart TV on food items that need to be bought. That data would integrate on the smartphone through the common account to create the next grocery list for us. In effect, a keyboard with a Smart TV will be the proxy for computers.

Technology will be the reliable partner

Technology will be the single biggest driver for the Smart TV boom. With high-speed Internet, the urban cities and towns are driving demand for Smart TVs right now. However, in the next 20 years, high speed Internet connectivity will reach deeper regions, and as 5G technology develops, the content consumption on Smart TVs is set to rise exponentially.

Technology is upgrading features regularly. Technologies, such as bezel-less and quantum dot, are improving the cinematic experience. A more recent advancement, 4K technology, is delivering high-quality visual content. OLED is making Smart TVs energy efficient as they consume less power and are more durable than LCD panels. Such technologies not only make Smart TVs environmentally more sustainable but also promote their demand in the commercial sector.

Constant innovation is the key

Smart TV technology must upgrade frequently and challenge its own limits to keep pace with customer preferences.

A key focus area of innovation in the coming two decades would be image quality and colours. High Dynamic Range (HDR) will continue to progress and develop as a base for the best video experience. It supports streaming content with a wider range of colours as compared to traditional models. HDR10 profile is the current minimum industry standard for OTT providers, which is driving the demand for HDR-enabled Smart TVs. With a special back-light system capable of delivering a